

This assignment has a total of 90 base points and 10 extra points, and the cap is 90. Bonus questions are indicated using the ★ mark.

Submission Instructions: Please submit to Gradescope (we will post the link later in the announcements). During submission, you need to **mark/map the solution to each question**; otherwise, we may apply a penalty.

Another notice: you only get full credits for the algorithm design questions if your algorithm matches the desirable complexity. If the desirable complexity is not stated, you need to design an algorithm to be as fast as possible.

Please specify the following information before submission:

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Problem 1: Asymptotic analysis [5 × 4 pts]

- (1) What's the asymptotic relationship between $f(n) = (\log \log n)^{\log n}$ and $g(n) = \log^{\log \log n} n$ and prove it?
- (2) What's the asymptotic relationship between $f(n) = 1 + \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{3} + \dots \frac{1}{n}$ and $g(n) = \sum_{i=1}^n 2^{-\lceil \log i \rceil}$ and prove it?
- (3) Prove that $n! = \omega(n^{0.99n})$.
- (4) In the practice table from the lecture, we have examples of f and g satisfying the following combinations of asymptotic relationships: $\{O, o\}$, $\{\Omega, \omega\}$, and $\{\Theta, O, \Omega\}$. Are there any other possible combinations? For every combination not in the listed three (combination also includes the empty set, or any singleton), construct an example of f and g and prove it.
- (5) What's the asymptotic relationship between $f(n) = n^{0.6}$ and $g(n) = 2^{\lfloor \log \log n \rfloor}$ and prove it?

Solution. (1)

$$f(n) = \omega g(n)$$

Proof:

$$\begin{aligned} \log f(n) &= \log (\log \log n)^{\log n} \\ &= \log n \log (\log \log n) \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\log g(n) &= \log(\log^{\log \log n} n) \\ &= \log \log n \log(\log n)\end{aligned}$$

Since $\frac{\log n}{(\log(\log n))^2} \rightarrow +\infty$ as $n \rightarrow +\infty$

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{f(n)}{g(n)} = \frac{\log n \log(\log \log n)}{(\log(\log n))^2} = +\infty$$

So, $f(n) = \omega g(n)$

(2):

Since $\log i \leq \lceil \log i \rceil \leq \log i + 1$

Then, $2^{-\lceil \log i \rceil} \geq 2^{-\log i - 1} = \frac{1}{2i}$

And $2^{-\lceil \log i \rceil} \leq 2^{-\log i} = \frac{1}{i}$

So, $\frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{1}{i} \leq \sum_{i=1}^n 2^{-\lceil \log i \rceil} \leq \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{1}{i}$

Thus, $1 + \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{3} + \dots + \frac{1}{n} = \Theta \sum_{i=1}^n 2^{-\lceil \log i \rceil}$

i.e. $f(n) = \Theta g(n)$

(3):

We first prove that $\log n! = \Theta(n \log n)$

$$\text{Since } \log(n!) = \log(1) + \log(2) + \dots + \log(n)$$

We have by monotonicity: $\log(n!) \leq \sum_{k=1}^n \log(n) = n \log(n)$

From the bound, we can use the fact that $\log(k) \geq \log(\frac{n}{2}), \forall k \geq \frac{n}{2}$

Thus, we can get:

$$\log(n!) \geq \sum_{k=\frac{n}{2}}^n \log(k) \geq \sum_{k=\frac{n}{2}}^n \log\left(\frac{n}{2}\right) = \frac{n}{2} \log\left(\frac{n}{2}\right)$$

$$\text{Since } \log n! = \Theta(n \log n)$$

$$\text{And } \log(n^{0.99n}) = 0.99n \log n = o(n \log n)$$

$$\text{So, } n! = \omega(n^{0.99n})$$

(4):

The possible combinations are: $\emptyset, \{\Omega\}, \{O\}$

For $\emptyset$, we can have: $f(n) = n, g(n) = n^{1+\sin(n)}$

For $\{\Omega\}$, we can have: $f(n) = \begin{cases} n^2, & \text{if } n \text{ is even} \\ n, & \text{if } n \text{ is odd} \end{cases}, g(n) = n$

For $\{O\}$, we can have: $f(n) = n \sin^2(n), g(n) = n$

(5): The asymptotic relationship is empty set $\emptyset$

Since we have

$$\begin{aligned} 2^{\log \log n - 1} &\leq 2^{\lfloor \log \log n \rfloor} \leq 2^{\log \log n} \\ 2^{0.5 \log n} &\leq 2^{2^{\lfloor \log \log n \rfloor}} \leq 2^{\log n} \\ n^{0.5} &\leq 2^{2^{\lfloor \log \log n \rfloor}} \leq n \end{aligned}$$

Since $n^{0.5} \leq n^{0.6} \leq n$, then

$$\liminf_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{f(n)}{g(n)} = 0, \limsup_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{f(n)}{g(n)} = +\infty$$

So, $f(n) = \emptyset g(n)$

Problem 2: Finding the maximum/minimum [10 + 10* pts]

For an array A of n *different* numbers (not necessarily sorted), we want to find the *largest* number and the *smallest* number in A simultaneously. However, we have no access to A . Instead, we are given an oracle COMPARE that can be used to compare the numbers in A . For $i \neq j$, COMPARE(i, j) returns i if $A[i] > A[j]$ and returns j if $A[j] > A[i]$ (recall that the numbers in A are different by assumption, so we cannot have $A[i] = A[j]$ if $i \neq j$). For convenience, let us assume n is even.

- (1) Design an algorithm which calls the COMPARE oracle at most $\frac{3}{2}n - 2$ times and returns a pair $(i_{\max}, i_{\min})$ such that $A[i_{\max}]$ (resp., $A[i_{\min}]$) is the largest (resp., smallest) number in A . Give the pseudocode and justify its correctness.
- (b)* Show that any algorithm has to call the COMPARE oracle $\frac{3}{2}n - 2$ times in worst case in order to find the largest and smallest numbers in A .

Solution.

Algorithm 1 Find the maximum and minimum indices in array A using at most $\frac{3n}{2} - 2$ comparisons

```
1: Initialize empty lists: CandidatesMax and CandidatesMin
2: for  $i = 1$  to  $n - 1$  step 2 do
3:   if COMPARE( $i, i + 1$ ) =  $i$  then
4:     Append  $i$  to CandidatesMax
5:     Append  $i + 1$  to CandidatesMin
6:   else
7:     Append  $i + 1$  to CandidatesMax
8:     Append  $i$  to CandidatesMin
9:   end if
10: end for
11:  $i_{\max} \leftarrow \text{CandidatesMax}[0]$ 
12: for each index  $j$  in CandidatesMax do
13:   if COMPARE( $j, i_{\max}$ ) =  $j$  then
14:      $i_{\max} \leftarrow j$ 
15:   end if
16: end for
17:  $i_{\min} \leftarrow \text{CandidatesMin}[0]$ 
18: for each index  $j$  in CandidatesMin do
19:   if COMPARE( $j, i_{\min}$ ) =  $i_{\min}$  then
20:      $i_{\min} \leftarrow j$ 
21:   end if
22: end for
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Ensure: $(i_{\max}, i_{\min})$

Proof. Let us define two sets:

- MAX : set of elements that could still be the maximum
- MIN : set of elements that could still be the minimum

Initially, all n elements belong to both MAX and MIN . To determine the maximum and minimum, the algorithm must eliminate $n-1$ elements from MAX and $n-1$ elements from MIN , for a total of $2n - 2$ eliminations.

The crucial insight is that a single comparison can eliminate at most 2 elements, one from each set. Specifically:

- When COMPARE(i, j) returns i , we can eliminate j from MAX and i from MIN .
- When COMPARE(i, j) returns j , we can eliminate i from MAX and j from MIN .

However, this maximum efficiency (eliminating 2 elements per comparison) is only possible when both elements being compared are in $MAX \cap MIN$. Once an element has been eliminated from one set but remains in the other, comparing it can only eliminate at most one element.

The optimal strategy involves first pairing up the elements and comparing each pair. After $\frac{n}{2}$ such comparisons:

- $\frac{n}{2}$ elements (the winners) remain in MAX but are eliminated from MIN
- $\frac{n}{2}$ elements (the losers) remain in MIN but are eliminated from MAX

At this point, we've eliminated $\frac{n}{2}$ elements from each set, with $\frac{n}{2}$ elements remaining in each. To determine the maximum, we need to eliminate $\frac{n}{2} - 1$ more elements from MAX , requiring at least $\frac{n}{2} - 1$ additional comparisons. Similarly, determining the minimum requires eliminating $\frac{n}{2} - 1$ more elements from MIN , needing at least $\frac{n}{2} - 1$ more comparisons.

Therefore, the total number of comparisons is at least:

$$\frac{n}{2} + \left(\frac{n}{2} - 1\right) + \left(\frac{n}{2} - 1\right) = \frac{3n}{2} - 2$$

□

Problem 3: Solving recurrences [4 × 5 + 5 pts]

- (1) Find big- Θ bounds for the following recurrences (and show your bounds are correct). For the base case, simply assume $T(n) = 1$ for all $n \leq 2$.
- (i) $T(n) = 8T(n/3) + n^{1.5} \log^4 n + 9n$
 - (ii) $T(n) = T(n - \sqrt{n}) + 6 \log n$
 - (iii) $T(n) = 2T(n/2) + \frac{n}{\log n}$
 - (iv) $T(n) = 5\sqrt{n} \cdot T(\sqrt{n}) + 2n$
- (2) Recall the Fibonacci sequence $F_0, F_1, F_2, \dots$ defined using the recurrence $F_n = F_{n-1} + F_{n-2}$ with the base case $F_0 = 0$ and $F_1 = 1$. Prove by induction that $\phi^{n-2} \leq F_n < \phi^n$ for all $n \geq 1$, where $\phi = (1 + \sqrt{5})/2$. Based on this, further show that $F_n = \Theta(\phi^n)$.

Solution.

- (1) (i) By master theorem, we have $a = 8, b = 3, f(n) = n^{1.5} \log^4 n + 9n$. Since $f(n) = O(n^{\log_3 8 - \epsilon})$ for $\epsilon = 0.5$, we have $T(n) = \Theta(n^{\log_3 8})$.

(ii) Let $m = \sqrt{n}$, then we have $T(m^2) = T(m^2 - m) + 12 \log m$.

So we have $T(m^2) = T(m - 0.5)^2 + 12 \log m - 0.25$

Let $S(m) = T(m^2)$

So we have $S(m) = S(m - 0.5) + 12 \log m - 0.25$

Since the step is 0.5, we have $S(m) = \Theta(m \log m)$

So we have $T(n) = \Theta(\sqrt{n} \log \sqrt{n}) = \Theta(\sqrt{n} \log n)$

(iii) By recursion tree, the i -th layer has the sum $\frac{n}{\log \frac{n}{i}}$ and we have $\log n - 1$ layers

So we have $T(n) = \sum_{i=0}^{\log n - 1} \frac{n}{\log n - i}$

Let $j = \log n - i$. We have

$$\begin{aligned} T(n) &= \sum_{i=0}^{\log n - 1} \frac{n}{\log n - i} \\ &= \sum_{j=\log n}^1 \frac{n}{j} \cdot (-1) \\ &= n \sum_{j=1}^{\log n} \frac{1}{j} \end{aligned}$$

we observe that:

$$\int_1^{\log n} \frac{1}{x} dx < \sum_{j=1}^{\log n} \frac{1}{j} < 1 + \int_1^{\log n} \frac{1}{x} dx$$

This gives us:

$$\ln(\log n) < \sum_{j=1}^{\log n} \frac{1}{j} < 1 + \ln(\log n)$$

In fact, it can be shown that as n grows large:

$$\sum_{j=1}^{\log n} \frac{1}{j} = \ln(\log n) + \gamma + O\left(\frac{1}{\log n}\right)$$

where $\gamma \approx 0.57721$ is the Euler-Mascheroni constant.

Therefore, the original sum has the asymptotic behavior:

$$\begin{aligned} T(n) &= n \sum_{j=1}^{\log n} \frac{1}{j} \\ &= n \cdot (\ln(\log n) + \gamma + o(1)) \\ &= n \ln(\log n) + \gamma n + o(n) \\ &= \Theta(n \log \log n) \end{aligned}$$

Thus, $T(n) = \Theta(n \log \log n)$.

(iv) Let $n = 2^m$, $S(m) = T(2^m) = T(n)$, then we have

$$S(m) = 5 \cdot 2^{m/2} \cdot S(m/2) + 2^{m+1}$$

Divide both sides by 2^m , we have

$$\frac{S(m)}{2^m} = 5 \cdot \frac{S(m/2)}{2^{m/2}} + 2$$

$$\text{Let } P(m) = \frac{S(m)}{2^m}$$

$$P(m) = 5 \cdot P(m/2) + 2$$

By master theorem, we have $a = 5, b = 2, f(m) = 2$

Since $f(m) = O(m^{\log_2 5 - \epsilon})$ for $\epsilon = 1$

we have $P(m) = \Theta(m^{\log_2 5})$

So, $S(m) = \Theta(2^m \cdot m^{\log_2 5})$

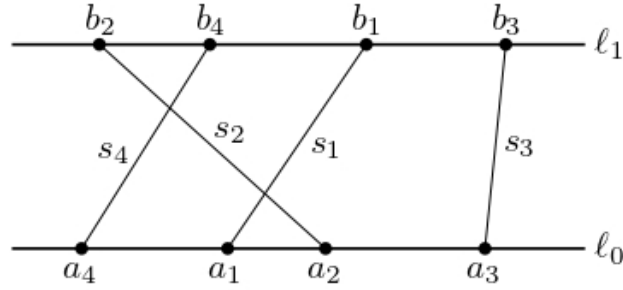
Thus, $T(n) = \Theta(n \cdot (\log n)^{\log_2 5})$

(2)

Problem 4: Counting intersection points [10 pts]

Consider two horizontal lines $\ell_0 : y = 0$ and $\ell_1 : y = 1$ in the plane. We have n distinct points $a_1, \dots, a_n$ on ℓ_0 and n distinct points $b_1, \dots, b_n$ on ℓ_1 . Note that the points $a_1, \dots, a_n$ and $b_1, \dots, b_n$ are *not* necessarily sorted by their x -coordinates. Now for each $i \in \{1, \dots, n\}$, we draw a segment s_i connecting a_i and b_i . See the figure below for an example of $n = 4$. These segments $s_1, \dots, s_n$ may intersect with each other, and for simplicity, we assume no three segments intersect at the same point. We aim to count the number of intersection points of $s_1, \dots, s_n$.

Formally, design an algorithm $\text{COUNTINT}(n, A, B)$ where $A[1 \dots n]$ stores the x -coordinates of $a_1, \dots, a_n$ and $B[1 \dots n]$ stores the x -coordinates of $b_1, \dots, b_n$. The algorithm should return the number of intersection points of the segments $s_1, \dots, s_n$, and should have time complexity $O(n \log n)$. Describe the basic idea and give the pseudocode. Then, justify its correctness and show it runs in $O(n \log n)$ time.



Solution. Please write down your solution to Problem 4 here.

Problem 5: 3SUM from 3 arrays [8 pts]

Given 3 non-empty and sorted arrays A, B, C of integers, each array is of size N_A , N_B and N_C respectively. Given an input a , output one value from each array such that the sum is equal to a . If not found, return 0. Design the algorithm, prove its correctness and complexity.

Solution. Please write down your solution to Problem 5 here.

Problem 6: Counting context-free grammar words [7 pts]

Context-free grammar (CFG) is an important concept in CS, and it recursively defines a set of strings/words. You may want to search for CFG and learn about the relevant context. In this problem, we omit many formal definitions and focus on the following grammar:

- (1) $S \rightarrow D \mid D + S$
- (2) $D \rightarrow 1D \mid 2D \mid 3D \mid 4D \mid \dots \mid 9D \mid 0 \mid 1 \mid 2 \mid 3 \mid \dots \mid 9$

The above two rules read as follows: we always start with S , and S can either get turned into D or $D + S$. Here, $+$ is a terminal symbol and cannot be transformed into other symbols. For the second rule, D can get transformed into $1D$ or $2D$ or $\dots$, and all the numbers are terminal symbols. The “ $\mid$ ” essentially means “or” for the transformation. A word satisfying the above CFG is a string of terminal symbols that can be generated using the above rules.

Think about what the above grammar represents. Count the number of words satisfying the above CFG of a given length n using recursion.

Solution. Please write down your solution to Problem 6 here.

Problem 7: Search for a root [10 pts]

Given a continuous function $f : [1, 2] \times [1, 2] \rightarrow [0, 1]$ with the “bi-monotone” property: $f(x, y) > f(x', y)$ if $x > x'$ and $f(x, y) > f(x, y')$ if $y > y'$, we want to solve for the root of $f(x, y) = a$ where a is some given value. The only access to f is an oracle such that given (x, y) , the oracle returns the value of $f(x, y)$.

Let R be the set of roots, i.e., $f(x^*, y^*) = a$ for any $(x^*, y^*) \in R$. We want to find an approximate solution $(\hat{x}, \hat{y})$ such that there exists $(x^*, y^*) \in R$ with $\hat{x} \leq x^* \leq (1 + \epsilon)\hat{x}$ and $\hat{y} \leq y^* \leq (1 + \epsilon)\hat{y}$ with as few oracle calls as possible. Here, $\epsilon > 0$ is another given parameter indicating the desirable level of accuracy. If there is no root, return 0.

Design an algorithm $\text{FINDROOT}(f, a, \epsilon)$, and prove its correctness and complexity (in terms of number of oracle calls). *This problem is a little bit more involved, but it does not require anything beyond the lectures. Suggest working on this after you finish everything else.*

Solution. **compute value using binary search**